

Chapter 140-2

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Chen Mian brought Liang Shi to a noodle shop.

The noodle shop was located near that middle school, in the deepest part of an alley. Business was slow.

However, it was very warm inside the shop. Shortly after entering, both Liang Shi and Chen Mian took off their coats.

"You brought a friend?" The owner greeted Chen Mian with a smile. "What are you having today?"

Chen Mian didn't ask for Liang Shi's opinion and ordered on her own: "Two bowls of saozhi noodles,¹ and a plate of pickled vegetables."

Liang Shi sat down with her.

Chen Mian pulled two napkins from the side, folded them neatly, and quietly wiped the oil stains on the wooden table.

She didn't talk to Liang Shi anymore.

Chen Mian had no awareness of entertaining a friend.

She was simply treating her to a meal.

The saozhi noodles were indeed very fragrant—better than any noodles Liang Shi had ever eaten before. With a spoonful of chili oil drizzled on top, it was very appetizing.

Liang Shi didn't hold back either.

After they finished eating, Chen Mian paid the bill.

She put on her worn coat again, looking unkempt.

The owner looked at the two of them and teased Chen Mian just as they were about to leave: "Where did you find such a good-looking friend?"

"Just found her randomly." Chen Mian said.

This time she didn't deny what the owner said.

When paying, the owner said: "This is your first time bringing a friend here—twenty percent off."

Chen Mian's hand paused while paying. She lowered her eyelashes and said: "This isn't the first time."

"Many years ago, I also brought someone here." Chen Mian said.

The owner was stunned, and only after a long while did she realize: "Oh, you mean that young girl. That was such a long time ago."

Chen Mian made a sound of acknowledgment, zipped her coat all the way up, and lazily waved at the owner. "Leaving now."

After coming out, the cold wind kept drilling into their clothes.

Liang Shi put her hands in her pockets and watched Chen Mian's back—it looked somewhat desolate.

She jogged a few steps to walk side by side with Chen Mian.

On both sides of the road, only some bare branches and shrubs remained.

The wind had blown this city into bleakness, without a trace of vitality.

After a moment, Liang Shi finally asked: "Have you ever thought about dating?"

Chen Mian was startled: "Who?"

"You." Liang Shi said: "After all, Qi Jiao... is gone."

"Never thought about it." Chen Mian didn't mind talking about Qi Jiao's death. She had a very good mindset when facing death, but her emotions were extremely pessimistic. "Who knows when I might die too. There's no point."

"Huh?" This answer startled Liang Shi. "I thought you just couldn't let go of Qi Jiao."

Chen Mian: "....."

"That too." Chen Mian didn't hide it. "But more than that, I just haven't met anyone I like."

"Alright then."

The topic ended there.

Chen Mian took Liang Shi for a walk around the area—just some after-meal exercise to help digestion.

After all, in Chen Mian's eyes, Liang Shi had also graduated from this school, so there was no need to show her around.

When they were about to part, Liang Shi hesitated but still said: "Someone wanted me to tell you—remember to listen to 'Solitary Bird Syndrome' before bed. Also, someone will love you."

She still helped convey Qi Jiao's words.

Chen Mian was stunned when she heard this. "Gu Xingyue?"

Liang Shi didn't say anything.

Chen Mian lowered her eyelashes. "That song was released a long time ago. Qi Jiao must have written it in her diary."

Liang Shi still didn't answer.

In exchange, Chen Mian warned Liang Shi coldly: "You should also stay away from Qin Lishuang."

Liang Shi: "Oh."

A flash of disdain passed through Chen Mian's eyes as she scoffed lightly: "That one's no good."

When cursing Qin Lishuang, Chen Mian's erhua accent² was particularly obvious.

The disgust and contempt in her tone were also very obvious.

"Got it." Liang Shi thought to herself: I've experienced even more than you have.

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1. Saozi noodles (臊子面) are a traditional noodle dish from Shaanxi province in China, featuring hand-pulled noodles topped with a savory meat sauce made from diced pork, along with various vegetables. It's known for its rich, flavorful broth. ↩
 2. Erhua accent (兒化音) refers to the addition of an "r" sound to the end of syllables, which is characteristic of northern Chinese dialects, particularly Beijing dialect. It often conveys a casual or colloquial tone. ↩